

ANGEL ACTION · BITES & STINGS

Jellyfish and Marine Stings

For tropical jellyfish (north of Bundaberg), flood the sting with vinegar for 30 seconds, then call 000. For bluebottle and other temperate stings, remove tentacles and immerse in hot water.

Tropical jellyfish (box jellyfish, Irukandji)

Anywhere north of Bundaberg, treat any jellyfish sting as potentially life-threatening.

1. **Call 000.**
2. Pour **vinegar** liberally over the sting for at least 30 seconds.
3. If no vinegar, pick off tentacles (they will not sting through gloved fingers; bare fingertips are usually OK briefly).
4. Be ready to start **CPR** — box jellyfish stings can cause cardiac arrest.

Bluebottle and other non-tropical jellyfish

1. Wash the area with seawater (not fresh water) to remove tentacles.
2. Do **not** use vinegar.
3. Immerse the area in **hot water** (no hotter than the rescuer can tolerate) for 20 minutes. A hot shower works.
4. If hot water is not available, use a cold pack for pain.

Stingray, stonefish, cone shell

Immerse the limb in **hot water** for up to 90 minutes. Call **000** — these stings can be fatal.

Blue-ringed octopus

Apply pressure immobilisation (as for **snake bite**) and call **000**. Be ready for CPR — the venom paralyses breathing muscles.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*